

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a lifestyle magazine:

Homeschooling

Homeschooling is a type of education where parents teach their children at home instead of sending them to school. There are different reasons why parents may choose to homeschool their kids: personal education beliefs, financial circumstances, health reasons, and so on.

Why is homeschooling so popular?

For some children, the pace of learning at school is simply too fast or too slow. At home, they get to set their own pace. It is also a flexible way of learning, giving families more time to spend together, as the kids can learn from anywhere. It can also be much cheaper than sending your child to a private school. Another benefit is that homeschoolers typically score 15-30% higher than public school students on tests. Here are some statistics.

Reasons for Homeschooling in the USA

Emphasis on family	8%
Health problems	4%
Moral/religious reasons	20%
Poor quality of education	15%
Safety	24%
Special educational needs	7%
Long commute to school	8%
Other reasons	14%

How about Hong Kong?

In Hong Kong, you won't hear of many students being homeschooled. While it isn't illegal, the government does push for parents to send their children to traditional schools.

Your group is discussing the idea of homeschooling in Hong Kong. You may want to talk about:

- pros of homeschooling
- cons of homeschooling
- whether homeschooling will become more popular in Hong Kong
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like studying at home?
2. Would you like to be homeschooled?
3. Do you think homeschooling would be easier than going to school?
4. Why don't parents in Hong Kong homeschool their children?
5. Do parents make good homeschooling teachers?
6. Why do you think homeschoolers score higher on tests?
7. Who would benefit most from homeschooling?
8. Do you think homeschooling is the future of education?